Program Overview & Funding Proposal

Building 4 Our Future · Building Today. Empowering Tomorrow. · Oct 22, 2026

Summary

Building 4 Our Future (B4OF) seeks **$123,200** to run three financial education programs in Chicago's underserved communities in its first year and reach **270 participants**. B4OF is an Illinois not-for-profit corporation formed in January 2026 and is preparing its application for 501(c)(3) recognition from the IRS. It has not yet received tax-exempt status.

Program	Who it serves	Year 1 target
Youth Financial Literacy Academy	Ages 13 to 25	80 completers
Community Wealth Workshops	Adults and families	150 completers
Entrepreneur Incubator	Side-hustlers and founders	40 founders, 15 businesses launched

B4OF teaches people what to do with money once they have it: budgeting, credit, ownership, business structure, and the basics of digital finance. Programs are delivered through trusted community partners such as schools, churches, libraries, and community centers, so B4OF does not carry the cost of its own buildings.

The need

Many people in underserved communities have income and drive but were never taught how to build assets. National data show gaps in banking access, savings, business survival, and homeownership that financial education alone cannot close, but that it can narrow.

Measure	Figure	Source
U.S. households with no bank account (2023)	4.2% (5.6 million households)	FDIC 2023 survey
Black households with no bank account vs. White households (2023)	10.6% vs. 1.9%	FDIC 2023 survey
Households that are underbanked (2023)	14.2% (about 19 million)	FDIC 2023 survey
Adults who could cover a $400 emergency with cash or its equivalent (2024)	63%, meaning about 37% could not	Federal Reserve SHED
New business establishments still operating after 10 years	34.7% of those opened in March 2013	BLS
Homeownership rate, Black households vs. non-Hispanic White households (Q4 2025)	44.2% vs. 75.1%	Census Bureau via FRED and FRED

B4OF's answer is structured, practical education that moves households from earning to owning: a budget they keep, credit they understand, a business built on a real structure, and an ownership plan for the next generation.

Mission, vision, and approach

Mission. B4OF empowers underserved communities through financial literacy, ownership education, and economic development, helping youth, families, and emerging entrepreneurs move from income dependence to long-term wealth building.

Vision. Every person has the financial knowledge to build stability, ownership, and generational wealth, regardless of where they start.

Approach.

- **Teach ownership, not just earning.** Each program asks participants to shift from "How much do I make?" to "What do I own?"
- **Start with youth, reach the household.** Young people carry what they learn back to parents, siblings, and neighbors.

- **Deliver where trust already exists.** Programs run in schools, churches, libraries, and community centers.
- **Measure what changes.** Every cohort is assessed before and after, and followed up at 3 and 6 months.
- **Keep digital finance educational.** Lessons on blockchain, digital payments, and Bitcoin explain how these systems work and what the risks are. B4OF does not give investment advice or recommend any asset.

The three programs

Program 1. Youth Financial Literacy Academy

An 8-week course for ages 13 to 25, one 90 to 120 minute session per week, delivered at schools, colleges, churches, libraries, youth organizations, and summer programs.

- **Learning areas:** money management; ownership mindset; entrepreneurship basics; how banks and credit work; digital finance basics.
- **Participants finish with:** a working budget, an understanding of assets and liabilities, a business idea, and a personal ownership action plan.

Program 2. Community Wealth Workshops

For adults and families, offered as a monthly series (one 2 to 3 hour workshop a month) or a 6-week intensive (one 2 to 3 hour class a week), hosted at churches, libraries, community centers, housing groups, and credit unions.

- **Learning areas:** purposeful budgeting; credit education and avoiding predatory lending; asset ownership; home ownership preparation; starting a business; digital finance as financial literacy.
- **Participants finish with:** a household budget kept for 90 days, a credit improvement plan, and a family financial structure plan.

Program 3. Entrepreneur Incubator

For local entrepreneurs, side-hustlers, and emerging founders, as an 8 to 12 week incubator (a weekly 2-hour workshop plus mentoring) or a quarterly cohort with pitch day and sponsor introductions.

- **Learning areas:** local business development; side hustle to real business; startup basics such as LLC formation, contracts, and taxes; sales and branding; cooperative and community ownership; scaling.
- **Participants finish with:** a legally registered small business, a customer acquisition plan, and a documented growth roadmap.

Planned: Youth Athletics and Mentoring (Year 2 pilot, not in the Year 1 budget)

B4OF plans to pair mentoring with basketball, baseball, and boxing for Chicago youth, with financial literacy sessions built into the program. It will be added after the board approves a plan, budget, and safety and background-check policies.

Targets and launch timeline

B4OF plans to serve **270 people in Year 1, 1,000 in Year 3, and about 2,100 in Year 5**. These are planning targets that depend on funding and partner capacity.

Year	Youth Academy	Adult Workshops	Entrepreneur Incubator	Total
Year 1	80	150	40	270
Year 2	160	300	100	560
Year 3	280	520	200	1,000
Year 4	420	750	360	1,530
Year 5	600	1,000	520	2,120

Other targets: **10 partner organizations and 15 businesses launched in Year 1**; **30 or more partners and 80 or more businesses by Year 3**; 100 or more businesses by Year 5. Year 1 assumes two cycles of each program (6 cycles). Year 3 assumes five cycles of each program (15 cycles).

Year 1 timeline. Month 1 is the first month funding is received.

Phase	Months	Key activities
1. Foundation	1 to 2	Hire Program Director. Contract lead facilitators. Finalize Youth Academy curriculum. Secure 3 to 5 anchor venues. Set up intake and tracking.

Phase	Months	Key activities
2. Curriculum	2 to 3	Finish Workshop and Incubator curricula. Produce workbooks. Build assessments and surveys.
3. Partner activation	3 to 4	Sign partner agreements. Launch outreach. Train and certify facilitators. Set up funder reporting.
4. Launch	4 to 8	Deliver first cohort of each program. Track outcomes. Run mid-cycle evaluations.
5. Evaluate	8 to 10	Complete first full cycles. Compile data and publish first Impact Report. Present to funders.
6. Scale	10 to 12	Start second cycles. Add 3 partner venues. Pilot train-the-trainer with one partner. Draft Year 2 plan.

How results are measured

B4OF reports what changes in participants' knowledge and behavior, not attendance alone. A semi-annual Impact Report shares results with funders, partners, and the public. B4OF will set outcome goals after its first cohorts and will report actual results, whatever they are.

What is measured	How	When
Enrollment and completion	Intake forms, attendance, graduation record	Monthly
Knowledge gain	Pre- and post-program assessment in all learning areas	Each cohort
Behavior change	3-month and 6-month follow-up surveys (budget adopted, savings started, credit actions)	Twice a year
Business outcomes	Registration verification, revenue and jobs reported by graduates	Quarterly
Community feedback	Partner organization feedback and participant stories	Annually

Participant data is collected with consent, kept private, and reported only in totals. Credit and income figures are self-reported unless a participant chooses to share documents.

Funding and sustainability

B4OF plans to reduce reliance on any single funder by combining several income sources. The goal is that by Year 3, about 40% of program delivery costs come from non-grant income.

Source	How it works	Notes
Foundation and corporate grants	Funding for financial literacy, youth, and entrepreneurship programs	Requires IRS recognition or a fiscal sponsor
Corporate sponsors	Banks, credit unions, and fintech companies with community commitments	Sponsor benefits must not become private benefit
Sliding-scale program fees	Participants pay what they can; no one is turned away for inability to pay	Fees support program costs only
Curriculum licensing and train-the-trainer	Schools and partner groups license B4OF curriculum	Begins after curriculum is proven, from Year 2
Annual community event	Fundraising event honoring graduates, donors, and partners	Year 2 or later

Risks and safeguards.

- **Low enrollment or distrust:** deliver through trusted partners such as schools and churches.
- **Dependence on one funder:** diversify funding from the first year.
- **Facilitator quality:** hire community members with lived experience, train and certify them, and evaluate them each quarter.
- **Drop-off between sessions:** use cohorts, peer accountability, and reminders.
- **Youth safety:** background checks for everyone who works with minors, two-adult supervision rules, and parent or guardian consent, written into B4OF policy before any youth session.

- **Financial advice:** staff and volunteers teach general education and do not give individual investment, tax, or legal advice.

Governance and staffing

Board. B4OF is governed by a volunteer Board of Directors of three to nine members, led by an independent Chair. A majority of directors must be unrelated to each other and unpaid by B4OF. The Board adopts a conflict of interest policy, approves all pay using comparable data, and reviews finances at every regular meeting. B4OF keeps its own bank accounts, books, and records, separate from any other organization or business. Any outside curriculum or content B4OF uses is licensed in writing and approved by directors with no conflict.

Year 1 staffing (funded in the budget below).

- Program Director, part-time (about 30 hours a week)
- Three lead facilitators, one per program, paid stipends as contractors
- Community Outreach Specialist, part-time
- Administrative Coordinator, part-time

Officers and directors are not paid in Year 1. An Executive Director will be hired only when funding allows. Positions are filled by a mix of professional credentials and lived experience in the communities served. B4OF prioritizes graduates and community members as facilitators and volunteers.

Community partners. Schools and districts, community colleges, libraries, community centers, faith organizations, credit unions and CDFIs, chambers of commerce and small business development centers, housing authorities, and neighborhood associations.

Year 1 budget

The Year 1 funding request is **$123,200**: $112,000 in program costs plus a 10% contingency reserve of $11,200.

Line item	Category	Annual cost	Share of total
Program Director, part-time (about 30 hours a week)	Personnel	$36,000	29.2%

Line item	Category	Annual cost	Share of total
Lead facilitators, 3 programs (stipends and prep)	Personnel	$18,000	14.6%
Community Outreach Specialist, part-time	Personnel	$10,000	8.1%
Administrative Coordinator, part-time	Personnel	$8,000	6.5%
Curriculum development, workbooks, and materials	Program	$12,000	9.7%
Venue and event costs, 3 programs, multiple sites	Program	$8,000	6.5%
Marketing, outreach, and digital presence	Operations	$6,000	4.9%
Technology, software, and digital tools	Operations	$5,000	4.1%
Facilitator training and professional development	Operations	$3,000	2.4%
Insurance, legal, compliance, and background checks	Operations	$6,000	4.9%
Contingency reserve (10% of $112,000)	Reserve	$11,200	9.1%
Total request		**$123,200**	**100%**

By category: personnel $72,000 (58.4%), program $20,000 (16.2%), operations $20,000 (16.2%), reserve $11,200 (9.1%).

Notes.

- **Program Director.** About 30 hours a week is the minimum needed to run three programs, manage partners, and produce funder reports.
- **Facilitators.** Stipends are paid as independent contractors. Whether the other roles are employees or contractors will be settled with a payroll or tax professional, and employer payroll taxes and workers' compensation will be added if those roles are employees.
- **Insurance, legal, and background checks.** Covers general liability insurance, nonprofit legal support for the tax-exempt filing, and background checks for anyone working with minors. This line is higher than in earlier drafts because youth programs require it.

- **Contingency.** A 10% reserve protects against delayed funder payments and unexpected costs.
- **Not budgeted in Year 1:** salaries for officers or directors, an Executive Director, and the planned youth athletics pilot.

Sources

- FDIC, 2023 National Survey of Unbanked and Underbanked Households: https://content.govdelivery.com/accounts/USFDIC/bulletins/3c16303
- Federal Reserve, Survey of Household Economics and Decisionmaking (unexpected expenses): https://www.federalreserve.gov/consumerscommunities/sheddataviz/unexpectedexpenses-table.html
- U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, business establishment survival: https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2024/34-7-percent-of-business-establishments-born-in-2013-were-still-operating-in-2023.htm
- FRED, Homeownership rate for Black households: https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/BOAAAHORUSQ156N
- FRED, Homeownership rate for non-Hispanic White households: https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/NHWAHORUSQ156N

Before this goes to a funder: confirm each statistic in the "need" section against the source page above and update the figures to the latest release. Building 4 Our Future is incorporated in Illinois and has applied for no federal tax-exempt status yet, so no donor should be told a gift is tax-deductible until the IRS recognizes the organization.